

I claim to have demonstrated the superiority of Family 35 based on size (number of representatives), independence (it is demonstrably independent of all other lines of transmission), age (it dates to the 3rd century, at least), geographical distribution (all over the Mediterranean area), profile (empirically determined), care (by the copyists) and range (all 27 books). I challenge any and all to do the same for any other line of transmission!

The Original Text is the ultimate archetype; any candidate must also be an archetype—a real, honest to goodness, objectively verifiable archetype; there is only one that has been identified so far—Family 35. I now move on to Part II, where I provide further evidence, the evidence that gives rise to my conclusions.

in the very first printed edition, the da Sabbio edition of 1539.